

KETCHUM GRENADE

Detonated by a percussion cap in its nose, the Ketchum grenade used cardboard stabilizing fins to help direct its flight. Thousands were used by the Union army and navy during the Civil War, in various sizes ranging between 1-5lb (0.5-2.2kg), often being tossed into enemy trenches during siege operations. They were not always reliable, and might be thrown back at the attacker. Another grenade was the Adams, a small, handheld weapon that resembled a tiny cannonball. In the heat of battle, instead of using a grenade, soldiers sometimes simply lit the fuses on artillery shells and heaved or rolled them over a defensive parapet into an attacking infantry force.

